

Finding your dominant planet

Score every planet on the 7 criteria (scale overleaf), add up, rank.

You need a complete natal chart: without a reliable birth time this is worthless.

CHART OF _____ DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ ASC _____

PLANET	1 Chart ruler	2 Angu- larity	3 Lumi- naries	4 Stel- lium	5 Dig- nity	6 Aspects received	7 Nb of aspects	TOTAL
☉ Sun								
☾ Moon								
☿ Mercury								
♀ Venus								
♂ Mars								
♃ Jupiter								
♄ Saturn								
♅ Uranus								
♆ Neptune								
♇ Pluto								

RANKING

1st — dominant

2nd

3rd

Gap 1st - 2nd

READ THE GAP, NOT JUST THE WINNER

Gap of 4 points or more: a clear dominant. One planet runs the chart.

Gap of 1 to 3: a qualified dominant. The second colours everything the first produces.

A dead heat: no dominant, a dominant pair — the two are read together.

The scale, criterion by criterion

- 1 Rulership of the Ascendant**
The planet that rules the Ascendant sign — your chart ruler.
5 pts — or 3 + 3 where the sign has two rulers (Scorpio, Aquarius, Pisces).
- 2 Angularity**
Distance to the nearest of the four angles: ASC, MC, DS, IC.
4 pts within 3° · 2 pts between 3 and 8° · failing that 2 pts in house I, IV, VII, X.
- 3 Link to the luminaries**
The Sun and Moon, and the planets ruling the signs they occupy.
2 pts per luminary · 2 pts to the Sun's dispositor · 2 pts to the Moon's (1 + 1 if two rulers).
- 4 Stellium**
Three or more planets in one sign or in one house.
1 pt per member · 2 pts to the ruler of the sign involved (1 + 1 if there are two).
- 5 Essential dignity**
How strong the planet is in the sign it occupies.
Domicile + 3 · exaltation + 2 · peregrine 0 · fall – 1 · detriment – 2.
- 6 Aspects received from the strong points**
Major aspects to the Sun, Moon, Ascendant or Midheaven.
2 pts within 3° · 1 pt out to 8° (6° for the sextile) · capped at 4 pts.
- 7 Most aspected planet**
The highest count of major aspects to the other planets.
2 pts, shared in the event of a tie.

ORBS USED

8° for major aspects involving the Sun, Moon, ASC or MC · 6° between two other planets · – 2° for the sextile.

Breaking a tie

1. The planet closer to an angle wins — it is the one other people see first.
2. Failing that, the one in domicile or exaltation: it acts without an intermediary.
3. Failing that, the one with the tightest orb to the Sun, Moon or Ascendant.
4. If nothing separates them: do not decide. Two dominants is information in itself.

The tie-break rule is decided before you see the scores. Never add an 8th criterion because the 7th did not settle it.

Three checks before you conclude

- ☐ Birth time — rerun at plus and minus 30 minutes. If the dominant changes, the time is not solid enough.
- ☐ The angle — does the dominant touch an angle, or rule the Ascendant? If not, be careful.
- ☐ The mirror — run it on someone else's chart. On yourself you recognise a bit of everything.

The full method, with a real chart worked end to end:

astro-cours.com/en/blog/dominant-planet-calculation-method